



Fuji-san Moments 富士山

The Omnipresence of the Sacred

聖なるものの遍在

You cannot see Mount Fuji (Fuji-san) from the city of Kyoto in any normal situation. Kyoto is located over 260 km (about 160 miles) west of Mount Fuji, and the view is blocked by intervening mountain ranges, making direct visibility impossible from ground level in the city or its commonly visited landmarks. I was in Kyoto for a Shotokai stage in 1985, and 40 years ago I was looking forward to seeing the mountain on a sunny day, and we only had one day; but we were so lucky, the weather was stable!

IS THERE ANY DIFFERENCE BETWEEN SHOTOKAI & SHOTOKAN?

No, they are the name of Shotokai's Hombu (main) Dojo (Shotokan) and the name of the association (Shotokai).



17/09/2025 – 09:27 Mt Fuji from Chureito Pagoda

There are, however, rare and highly specific situations where seeing Mount Fuji from the far edge of Kyoto Prefecture might be possible. Research by a Japanese geography teacher suggests that, under exceptionally clear weather conditions and from the right mountaintop location in eastern Kyoto Prefecture—close to the border with Shiga—one could theoretically see the very summit of Mt. Fuji protruding above the distant mountains. Such a sighting is extremely rare and only achievable for experienced hikers/photographers with the help of geographic simulations, specialized equipment, and optimal atmospheric clarity.

For visitors, the best way to see Fuji-san from the Kyoto area is by taking the Tokaido Shinkansen (bullet train) from Kyoto toward Tokyo. From the train, Fuji-san becomes visible for a few minutes near Shin-Fuji station, provided the weather is clear and you sit on the correct side of the train (left side from Kyoto to Tokyo).



17/09/2025 – 10:06 Mt Fuji from Chureito Pagoda

The best way for travellers to spot Mount Fuji when traveling from Kyoto is through the windows of the Tokaido Shinkansen (bullet train) rather than from natural viewpoints in Kyoto itself. You cannot see Mount Fuji from standard tourist locations in Kyoto city or from public viewpoints due to the distance and intervening mountains.

Shinkansen (Bullet Train)

- Most reliable and iconic view for tourists: Take the Tokaido Shinkansen from Kyoto to Tokyo.
- Where to sit best: For the best view, sit on the left side of the train facing the direction of travel toward Tokyo (a seat E in standard class, D in Green Car).
- Where you see Fuji: The mountain comes into view for several minutes near Shin-Fuji station, about halfway between Kyoto and Tokyo, weather permitting.

Tips:

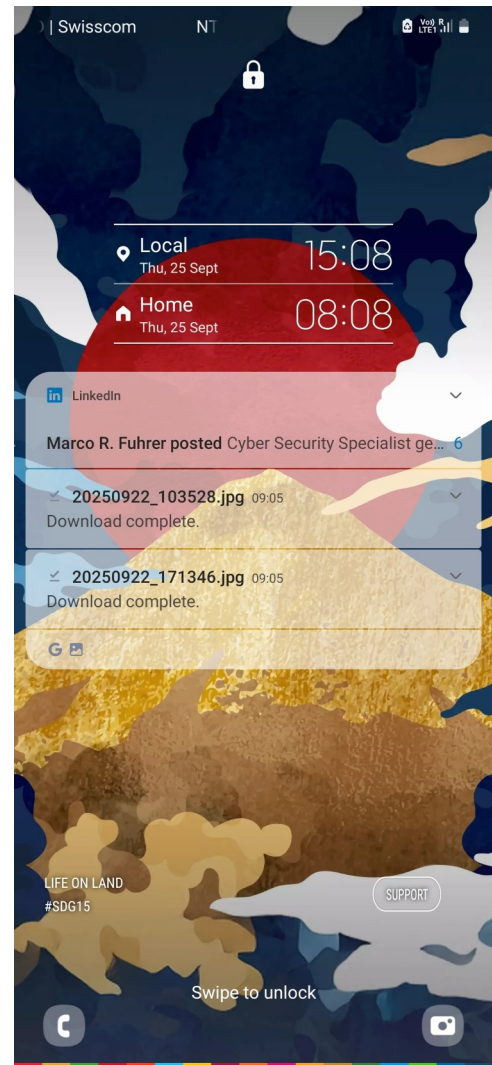
Fuji is visible faster when heading toward Tokyo than in the opposite direction. Weather is crucial—a clear day is needed for a good view.



The windows of the Shinkansen bullet train between Kyoto and Tokyo are by far the best and most practical way for visitors in Kyoto to see Mount Fuji. Public viewpoints or city locations in Kyoto do not offer a view of Fuji-san.

You can see Mount Fuji from the train on several different train journeys. However, one train offers the best views of Japan's iconic mountain: the Fujisan View Express.

The Fujisan View Express features an interior that looks more like a cafe than a train, and the staff on board helps create a premium travel experience.



The Fuji Five Lakes area north of Mount Fuji is squeezed between the majestic mountain and the Japanese Alps. Like many other places in Japan, a small community railway connects the area. But this community railway is different. It does not only serve the community (with local trains running once every 30 minutes), but it also serves visitors who want a particularly great view of Mount Fuji.

Another great time for scenic views is during Sakura season. Typically, the cherry blossoms flower from mid-March to mid-April, although it can be considerably earlier. The effects of global warming also affect cherry blossoms.

The other season when the views becomes extra scenic is Fall. The bright yellow and red leaves mix with the green of conifers to form a dusty, purplish, deep orange, which makes for a great contrast with the majesty of Mount Fuji.



It rises to 12,388 feet (3,776 metres) near the Pacific Ocean coast in Yamanashi and Shizuoka ken (prefectures) of central Honshu, about 60 miles (100 km) west of the Tokyo-Yokohama metropolitan area.

Max Kleiner, Text & Photos, October 2025

Ref: [Fujisan View Express - The Best Way To See Mt Fuji On A Train](#)

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